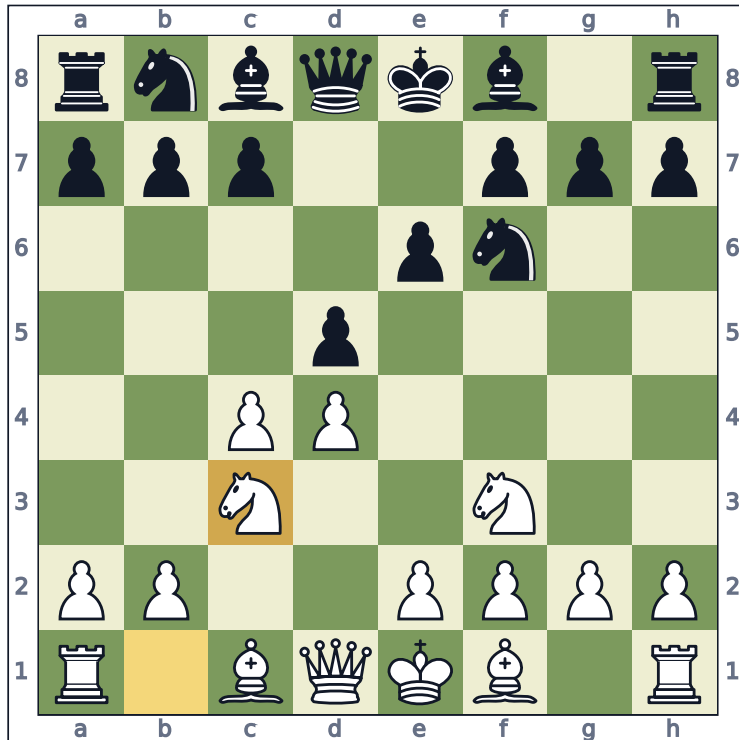


QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

Queen's Gambit Declined

ECO D37 | 15 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.37 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D37 covers Queen's Gambit Declined. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Queen's Gambit Declined: Three Knights Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

BLACK'S GOALS

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. A gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D37 line

This section preserves all 15 names and defining routes assigned to D37 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Queen's Gambit Declined: Barmen Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Nbd7

002 Queen's Gambit Declined: Harrwitz Attack

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Be7 5. Bf4

003 Queen's Gambit Declined: Harrwitz Attack

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Be7 5. Bf4 O-O 6. e3 c5 7. dxc5 Bxc5 8. Qc2 Nc6 9. Rd1 Qa5 10. a3

004 Queen's Gambit Declined: Harrwitz Attack

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Be7 5. Bf4 O-O 6. e3 c5 7. dxc5 Bxc5 8. Qc2 Nc6 9. a3 Qa5 10. O-O-O

005 Queen's Gambit Declined: Harrwitz Attack, Fianchetto Defense

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Be7 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. Bf4 O-O 6. e3 b6

006 Queen's Gambit Declined: Harrwitz Attack, Main Line

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Be7 5. Bf4 O-O 6. e3 c5 7. dxc5 Bxc5

007 Queen's Gambit Declined: Harrwitz Attack, Orthodox Defense

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Be7 5. Bf4 O-O 6. e3 c6

008 Queen's Gambit Declined: Harrwitz Attack, Two Knights Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Be7 5. Bf4 O-O 6. e3 Nbd7

009 Queen's Gambit Declined: Harrwitz Attack, Two Knights Defense, Blockade Line

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 d5 4. Nf3 Be7 5. Bf4 O-O 6. e3 Nbd7 7. c5

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D37 line

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010 Queen's Gambit Declined: Knight Defense, Alekhine Gambit

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Nbd7 5. Bg5 h6 6. Bh4 dxc4

011 Queen's Gambit Declined: Miles Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 Be7 5. Bg5 O-O 6. Qc2

012 Queen's Gambit Declined: Three Knights Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3

013 Queen's Gambit Declined: Three Knights Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Be7 5. e3 O-O

014 Queen's Gambit Declined: Three Knights, Vienna Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 dxc4

015 Queen's Gambit Declined: Vienna Variation, Quiet Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. e3